At Bretton Woods, the Indian delegation had four main concerns: the extension of the purposes of the Fund to include economic development; equitable settlement of the sterling balances problem; securing a satisfactory quota for India; and a permanent seat (appointed as opposed to elected) on the Executive Board of the Fund and the Bank. Deshmukh was nominated as the Chairman of Committee 4 of Commission II which dealt with the form and status of the Bank for Reconstruction and Development (ultimately called the International Bank for Reconstruction and Development and better known as the World Bank). He felt that given India's size and importance, the Indian delegation could have been larger. It would also have helped cope with the problem of attendance on numerous committees which often sat at the same time. 'Many of the smaller countries had delegations as large as ours, and I think there was scope for a larger delegation on our behalf considering the size and importance of the country. While it was recognized that our delegation was a hand-picked and a high-powered one, it suffered from the disadvantage that we could not spare many members for chairmanships of committees, especially as many as four Committees even sat at the same time. We, however, conserved our energies and manpower for pressing forward our own special view points.'[16]

Despite its small size, the Indian delegation's role and contribution belied its small size or its political status. It was also unique insofar that it represented the only non-self-governing country participating in the Conference. The Indian delegation proposed two major amendments to Article I (ii) which concerned the purposes of the Fund. The first amendment called the Fund 'to assist in the fuller utilization of the resources of economically underdeveloped countries', and the second for the settlement of 'abnormal indebtedness arising out of the war'. The first amendment which was supported by Ecuador was opposed by the United Kingdom and South Africa on the ground that the development of underdeveloped countries was regarded as a subject for the Bank rather than for the Fund. To counter this criticism, India proposed a revision of Article I (ii) which called for 'the development of the resources and productive power of all member countries with due regard to the needs of economically backward countries'.[17] Deshmukh observed that they were successful in getting a minor provision included in a modified form in the scheme of the Fund and the Bank. The provision was that in recruiting staff